

Word family: **fall** / falls / fell / fallen / falling

Base word: fall

Forms: falls, fell, fallen, falling

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞)

Your sentence:

> "...which, to be honest, is a trap people **fall into** all the time."

Meaning in this passage

Here, **fall into** means **to become involved in an undesirable situation or pattern, often without intending to**.

In your sentence:

fall into a trap = 掉進陷阱；比喻不知不覺陷入某種不理想的情況或習慣

中文翻譯：

> "...is a trap people **fall into** all the time."

「.....這就是很多人常常會**掉進去 / 陷入其中**的陷阱。」

Important: **fall into** is a phrasal construction, and because it is essential to the exact target sentence, it should be mapped explicitly even though phrasal verbs are normally excluded by default.

1. **fall** = move downward because of gravity (掉落) — 掉下；落下

Meaning: To move from a higher position to a lower one, usually because of gravity.

Practice 1

> "The glass **fell** from the table."

「玻璃杯從桌上**掉了下來**。」

Practice 2

> "Leaves were **falling** from the trees."

「樹葉正從樹上**落下**。」

****fall = 由高處向低處移動或掉落****

Common:

* fall to the ground

* fall from a height

* fall off a chair

2. ****fall = lose balance and end up on the ground (跌倒) — 跌倒；摔倒****

****Fall**** can mean that a person loses balance and goes to the ground.

Practice 3

> “He slipped and ****fell****.”

「他滑了一跤，****跌倒了****。」

Practice 4

> “She ****fell**** on the stairs.”

「她在樓梯上****摔倒了****。」

****fall = 身體失去平衡而倒在地上****

This is closely related to Meaning 1, but learner-facing distinction is useful.

3. ****fall = decrease in amount, level, price, temperature, etc. (下降) — 下降；下跌****

Practice 5

> “Prices ****fell**** sharply.”

「價格大幅****下跌****。」

Practice 6

> “The temperature ****fell**** below zero.”

「氣溫****降到****零度以下。」

****fall = 數量、水平、價格、溫度等向較低水平下降****

Common:

- * prices fall
- * temperature falls
- * unemployment falls
- * sales fall

This is a major figurative sense.

4. ****fall = become a particular state (進入某狀態) — 變得 ; 陷入****

****Fall**** appears in many constructions meaning ****enter a state****, often gradually or unintentionally.

Practice 7

> “The room ****fell silent****.”

「房間突然****安靜下來****。」

Practice 8

> “He ****fell asleep**** during the film.”

「他看電影時****睡着了****。」

Practice 9

> “She ****fell ill**** after the trip.”

「她旅行後****病倒了****。」

****fall + adjective/state = 進入某種狀態****

Common:

- * fall asleep
- * fall silent
- * fall ill
- * fall unconscious
- * fall quiet

This is a major grammatical-semantic branch.

5. **fall into = enter an undesirable situation/pattern (陷入) — 陷入 ; 掉進**

This is the exact meaning used in your passage.

Practice 10 — Original

> “It is a trap people **fall into** all the time.”

「這是很多人經常會**陷入**的陷阱。」

Practice 11

> “It is easy to **fall into** bad habits.”

「人很容易**養成 / 陷入**壞習慣。」

Practice 12

> “The company **fell into** financial difficulty.”

「公司**陷入**財政困難。」

fall into = 不知不覺進入某種狀況、習慣、問題或困境

This develops from the broader “enter a state” sense.

6. **fall = belong/be placed within a category (分類) — 屬於 ; 歸入**

Practice 13

> “These cases **fall** into three categories.”

「這些案例可**分成 / 歸入**三個類別。」

Practice 14

> “The issue **falls** under local law.”

「這個問題**屬於**本地法律的範圍。」

****fall into/under a category = 被歸入某個類別、範圍或制度之內****

This is an established abstract classification use.

7. ****fall = be defeated or collapse (失守 / 倒下) — 倒下 ; 失守 ; 垮台****

Cities, governments, regimes, organizations, etc. can ****fall****.

Practice 15

> “The city ****fell**** after a long siege.”

「這座城市在長期圍城後****失守****。」

Practice 16

> “The government ****fell**** after the crisis.”

「政府在危機後****垮台****。」

****fall = 因失敗、攻擊或危機而失去控制、權力或穩定****

This is a major historical/political extension.

8. ****fall = die in battle (陣亡) — 陣亡 ; 倒下****

Practice 17

> “Many soldiers ****fell**** in battle.”

「許多士兵在戰鬥中****陣亡****。」

This is a more literary/formal use.

For core counting, I would usually keep it under Meaning 7.

9. ****fall = occur on a particular date/day (日期) — 適逢 ; 落在****

Practice 18

> “Christmas ****falls**** on a Friday this year.”

「今年聖誕節****適逢****星期五。」

Practice 19

> “The holiday ****falls**** in late September.”

「這個假期****落在****九月底。」

****fall on** = 日期、節日等剛好出現在某一天 / 時段******

This is a distinct calendar use.

10. ****fall** = begin to love someone (fall in love) — 愛上******

Practice 20

> “They ****fell in love**** quickly.”

「他們很快就****愛上了彼此****。」

This is a fixed expression.

I would not count it as an independent base meaning because it belongs to the broader “enter a state” branch.

11. ****fall** = become the responsibility/share of someone (落到) — 落在；由……承擔******

Practice 21

> “The responsibility ****fell to**** me.”

「這個責任****落到了我身上 / 由我承擔****。」

Practice 22

> “The task ****fell to**** the youngest member.”

「這項任務****落在****最年輕的成員身上。」

****fall to someone** = 某項責任、任務或決定由某人承擔******

This is an established abstract construction.

12. **fall = autumn (名詞 , 美式英語) — 秋天**

As a noun, **fall** can mean **autumn**, especially in American English.

Practice 23

> “The leaves change colour in the **fall**.”

「樹葉在**秋天**變色。」

Practice 24

> “Classes begin in the **fall**.”

「課程在**秋季**開始。」

fall = 秋天 / 秋季

This is a genuinely distinct noun meaning.

13. **fall = act of falling / decline (名詞) — 跌落 ; 下降**

Practice 25

> “He had a bad **fall**.”

「他狠狠**摔了一跤**。」

Practice 26

> “There was a sharp **fall** in prices.”

「價格出現大幅**下跌**。」

These are noun counterparts of the verb senses.

Related form: **fallen**

****Fallen**** has several useful uses.

literal

> “fallen leaves”

「落葉」

defeated/collapsed

> “a fallen empire”

「已衰亡 / 已垮台的帝國」

dead in battle

> “fallen soldiers”

「陣亡士兵」

These remain tied to the main ****fall**** branches.

Important distinction: ****fall vs drop****

****drop****

can be transitive or intransitive:

> “She dropped the glass.”

> “The glass dropped.”

****fall****

is normally intransitive:

> “The glass fell.”

Not:

> “She fell the glass.” ❌

So:

****drop = can cause something to fall****
****fall = subject itself moves downward****

Important distinction: ****fall vs decline****

****fall****

is common and broad.

****decline****

is more formal and often used for gradual reduction.

- > prices fell sharply
- > population declined gradually

They overlap in numerical contexts.

Important distinction: ****fall vs decrease****

****decrease****

is neutral and technical.

****fall****

is more everyday and vivid.

- > costs decreased
- > costs fell

Both can work.

Important distinction: ****fall vs collapse****

****fall****

can mean lose power/control or decrease.

****collapse****

suggests sudden and serious failure or breakdown.

- > government fell
- > system collapsed

Collapse is usually stronger.

Important distinction: **fall into** vs **enter**

enter

is neutral.

fall into

often suggests:

- * unintentionally
- * gradually
- * undesirably

- > enter a routine
- > fall into a bad routine

The latter carries a stronger sense of slipping into it.

Grammar note: **fall** is irregular

Present:

- > fall / falls

Past:

- > **fell**

Past participle:

- > **fallen**

-ing:

> falling

So:

> fall → fell → fallen

Useful construction: **fall apart** — 分崩離析；散開

This is a common phrasal verb:

> “The plan fell apart.”

「計劃**崩潰 / 瓦解**了。」

Under our normal SOP, this remains outside the core unless specifically targeted.

Useful construction: **fall behind** — 落後

> “He fell behind in class.”

「他在課堂進度上**落後**了。」

Again, phrasal extension rather than a separate core meaning.

Useful construction: **fall for** — 上當 / 愛上

> “She fell for the trick.”

「她**中了圈套 / 上當**了。」

This is another highly lexicalized phrasal verb, but it is not part of the current target sentence.

Family-extension note

The practical family includes:

* **fall** *

* **falls**
 * **fell**
 * **fallen**
 * **falling**

This word has a very broad semantic network built around the underlying image of **moving downward or entering a lower/new state**.

The main curation challenge is to avoid turning every fixed phrase into a separate sense while still preserving genuinely distinct branches such as:

- * physical downward movement
- * numerical decrease
- * state change
- * defeat/collapse
- * calendar placement
- * autumn

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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fall — physical downward movement	因重力或失去支撐而由高處向低處移動；掉下、落下
fall — lose balance	身體失去平衡而跌倒
fall — decrease	價格、數量、水平或溫度等下降
fall + state	進入某種狀態，如 fall asleep / silent / ill
fall into	不知不覺進入某種狀況、問題、習慣或困境
fall — category	被歸入某個類別或範圍
fall — defeat/collapse	城市、政府、組織等失守、倒台或垮下
fall on a date	日期、節日等適逢某一天
fall to someone	某項責任或任務落到某人身上
fall — noun, autumn	秋天 / 秋季
a fall — noun	一次跌倒；亦可指數值下降

For your original sentence

> “...is a trap people **fall into** all the time.”

The exact meaning is:

****fall into = 不知不覺陷入某種不理想的模式、情況或習慣****

So:

> ****fall into a trap****

= **掉進陷阱 / 陷入圈套**

Here the trap is metaphorical:

> repeatedly postponing something while telling yourself you will do it later.

For your database, I would count **6 genuinely useful core meanings** for **fall**:

1. **move downward / lose balance**
2. **decrease in amount or level**
3. **enter a state**
4. **be defeated/collapse**
5. **occur on a date/day**
6. **noun: autumn**

I would keep **fall into** under the state-change branch, treat classification and responsibility constructions as useful extensions, and keep other phrasal verbs such as **fall apart / fall behind / fall for** outside the core unless targeted.